

RECORD OF PROCEEDINGS FOR THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE

Office of City Clerk

March 16, 2026

The Governing Body of the City of Cheyenne convened in a special meeting on this date beginning at 6:00 p.m. in City Council Chambers for the purpose of collective labor bargaining with the Cheyenne Professional Fire Fighters, International Association of Fire Fighters, Local No. 279. Present were: MAYOR – Patrick Collins; COUNCIL MEMBERS – Dr. Aldrich, Dr. Emmons, Mr. Esquibel, Mr. Laybourn, Mr. Moody, Mr. Segrave and Mr. White. Absent: Dr. Rinne and Mr. Wolfe. Also present: Kylie Soden, City Clerk; John Brodie, City Attorney; Amber Ash, Mayor’s Chief of Staff; Robin Lockman, City Treasurer and Chief Andrew Dykshorn, Deputy Chief Don Wood and Deputy Chief of Administrative Services, Glenn Rodgers, Cheyenne Fire Rescue. The pledge of allegiance was recited.

Chris Thoms, President of Local #279, emphasized the Union’s priority of maintaining fair market wages and noted that peer departments, including those along the Front Range, provide relevant comparisons. Jason Lindsay, Vice President of Local #279, presented pension and salary comparisons for firefighters in Wyoming, Colorado, and Montana. Discussion included specialty pay, Cheyenne’s economic growth, and cost-of-living data sourced from bestplaces.net. Mr. Thoms presented a counter proposal which included updates to Section 19 – Inclement Weather and Section 21 – Classification of Employment and Basic Wages. Additional discussion included recruitment efforts, attrition history, firefighter candidate pools, appropriate peer comparisons, the importance of aligning recurring revenues with recurring expenses, as well as the City’s use of reserves.

Pursuant to Wyoming State Statute §16-4-405(a)(x), Mr. Segrave moved to meet in executive session, seconded by Mr. White. Motion carried. Voting “yes” – all members of the governing body present. The following staff members were in attendance: Amber Ash, Mayor’s Chief of Staff; John Brodie, City Attorney; Robin Lockman, City Treasurer; Kylie Soden, City Clerk and Chief Andrew Dykshorn, Deputy Chief Don Wood and Deputy Chief of Administrative Services, Glenn Rodgers, Cheyenne Fire Rescue. [City Clerk note: audio and video recording of the special meeting was stopped; Executive Session convened at 6:41 p.m. in the City Council office]

Following closure of the executive session, Mayor Collins reconvened the special meeting at 7:06 p.m. and discussion continued regarding wage comparisons, specialty pay, and appropriate peer groups, including how comparable communities structure and fund compensation. Mayor Collins expressed the belief that the City’s firefighters are not underpaid. Discussion also included cost-of-living comparisons among certain Wyoming communities, paramedic compensation and training considerations, and ongoing challenges in reaching an agreement on wage comparisons and the identification of appropriate peer groups. The City reiterated its standing offer related to wage increases. The Union requested adjournment to review rank average amounts provided by the City.

There being no further business to come before the governing body, the meeting was officially adjourned at 7:35 p.m.

Submitted by,

Kylie Soden,
City Clerk

This notice is available in alternative, accessible formats upon request.

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